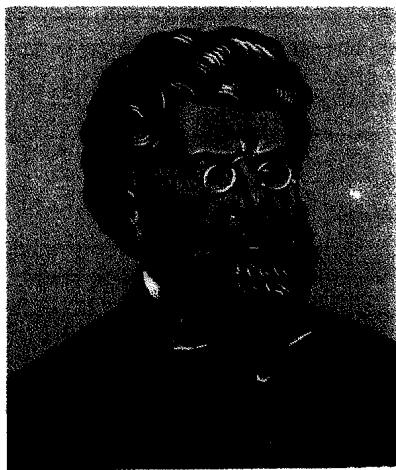




Georges Bizet was born in Paris, October 25, 1838. His mother taught him the rudiments of music when he was only four years of age and he was sent to the Conservatory before he was nine. He won the Grand Prix de Rome when he was nineteen and while studying in Italy he submitted, instead of the prescribed Mass, an Opera which was highly praised. He was a remarkably fine pianist although he did not perform in public. His fame and renown rest upon his two *L'Arlésienne Suites* and the opera, *Carmen*, which placed him in the front rank of modern French composers. The example following is from the first act of *Carmen* and shows the scene wherein Carmen sings and dances in her attempt to captivate Don José, a Spanish captain of the guard. A *Habanera* is a Spanish song and dance which really dates back to Africa by way of Cuba. It was first imported into Cuba by negro slaves after which it naturally found its way into Spain. As in all dance forms *rhythm is uppermost*. Note the alla breve TIME—which means two counts to the bar and one count to each minim. Learn it first, however, in four-four time. Let the staccato be sharp and brittle and do not overlook the two-note slur in each bar.

Habanera from "Carmen"

Bizet (1838-1875)

Moderato

The musical score is presented in four systems, each containing a treble and bass staff. The tempo is marked 'Moderato'. The key signature is one flat (B-flat). The melody is written in the treble staff, and the bass staff provides a harmonic accompaniment. The piece is characterized by its staccato eighth-note rhythm. Fingerings and slurs are indicated throughout the score. The piece concludes with a double bar line and a key signature change to two sharps (F# and C#).

Musical score for piano, consisting of four systems of staves. The key signature is two sharps (F# and C#), and the time signature is 2/4. The score includes various musical notations such as notes, rests, and dynamic markings.

System 1: The first system begins with a forte (*f*) dynamic marking. It features a series of eighth and sixteenth notes in the right hand, with corresponding bass notes in the left hand.

System 2: The second system continues the melodic line, ending with a fortissimo (*ff*) dynamic marking.

System 3: The third system maintains the rhythmic pattern, with a fortissimo (*ff*) dynamic marking appearing towards the end.

System 4: The fourth system concludes the piece with a final fortissimo (*ff*) dynamic marking.

